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SEMESTER 1, 2025/2026

LPE2504 CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS
PORTFOLIO 1 (25%)

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST		
ITEMS		TICK (✓)
TASK 1	Literary Elements Analysis	
TASK 2	Revised Free Form Poem	

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PO1 (5%)	PO3 (10%)	PO4 (10%)
/12 marks	/10 marks	/10 marks

LPE2504 CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS**PORTFOLIO 1 (25%)****(FREE FORM POEM)****Overview**

The objective of this portfolio is to assess your ability in analysing the effectiveness of literary devices used in poems to convey specific message and tone. It is divided into 2 tasks:

- Task 1 focuses on analysing and evaluating a free form poem
- Task 2 focuses on improving a free form poem.

This portfolio is to be completed individually.

Weekly Task Schedule

WEEK	TASK
Week 8	Task 1 - Choose and study one of the free form poems listed below: <i>A Family of Friends</i> <i>Beautiful Nature</i> <i>The Corner of the Road</i> <i>The Dimming Star</i> <i>Will It Change?</i> - Identify three literary elements used in the chosen poem and evaluate the effectiveness of the literary elements by completing the form provided.
Week 9	Task 2 Rewrite the chosen poem to display effective use of literary devices while retaining the original tone, message and structure.
Week 10	Compile both completed Task 1 and Task 2 and submit Portfolio 2.

Task 1: Analysis of Literary Elements

Task Description

Choose **ONE** of the free form poems below for the analysis of literary devices.

Poem 1: A Family of Friends

How unexpected it was, when our paths crossed,
When an opportunity came knocking on our door,
Uniting us to swish swoosh on the dance floor.
Not long after that, we all sat down to chat,
We listened, giggled and sobbed after sharing all our past,
Little did we know, this was just the start of something more meaningful.
The woefulness of eating a delicious dinner together,
The happiness of cracking jokes with each other,
The thrill of every late night drive,
With each memory, we created a connection that surpassed gender and religion,
A bond in which we care like a tyrant, we protect like a father.
We are now far apart and it breaks my little heart,
But we shall meet soon my loves, when the virus departs.

by anonymous

Poem 2: Beautiful Nature

Looking at the bright sky, I feel
it is so artful, dangerous, and wonderful.
This nature has existed many moons ago,
here I am enjoying the view while slurping my creamy cappuccino.

I wonder how soft the clouds are,
and where will the clouds go, where?
I wonder if the sun is a dark shadow hanging in the sky,
beaming in my eyes, filling the sky with brilliance when it shines.

The crystal-clear ocean is as wide as the sky.
It is sombre and shimmering, so mesmerising.
The golden green grasses go glamorous glimmering
around me, dancing back and forth with the summer breeze happily.

Now I sit on this lovely beach calmly,
breathing in the fresh cold air deeply,
closing my eyes slowly when the breeze caresses my face gently.

by anonymous

Poem 3: *The Corner of the Road*

Bang!

Silently, it dragged its leg and limped
enduring the pain of its bleeding limb.
Silently, it sniffed, licked, and crowed,
all alone at the corner of the road.

Green river, it gushed out of the lake of red;
Golden furs, they drifted as they get shed.
Lifelessly, it laid; Hopelessly, it waited
all alone at the corner of the road.

That night, there was nothing but happiness;
 No more lively nights, no more midnight fights;
 No more familiar barks, no more territories marked.
 No more of its familiar presence,
 yet no one questioned, and no one realised, as its remnants laid
 all alone at the corner of the road.

by anonymous

Poem 4: *The Dimming Star*

Like the brightest star pridefully swimming and twinkling,
 Decorating, illuminating the stretch of black canvas. Never stop glowing, never rest,
 To shine brighter, to shine the best.

A sense that used to be my pride now is helping me,
 Choked by the rough vicious image created by no one but me,
 A vivid but vague reflection I see,
 On the mirror, in my eyes,
 An image that I don't recognise,
 An image that is me, but I can't see,
 Me.

Panic resides within me that I am trapped in a maze, Escitalopram accompanying,
 From the brightest star now is dimming,
 Losing its shine, losing its worth,
 Lost within the black canvas that is now an endless void.

Now the bright, shining star becomes a lively android.

by anonymous

Poem 5: *Will It Change?*

Will it change?

If I had loved you better

If I had understood your cues, your grunts of pain, the silent scream

If I had felt your joy, how excruciating it must be

Will it change?

If I had perceived the signs earlier

The way your soft, prickly coat

Turned dull and coarse

How your soulless eyes, always beaming

Had lost its sparkle, the energy drained from your soul

Will it change?

If I were there with you in your last moments

If all of these didn't happen

Will it change?

Will you still be here?

by anonymous

Task 1: Literary Elements Analysis

Based on the chosen poem, identify and highlight three literary devices used and complete the table below.

Poem Title: The Corner of the Road
<i>Extract the assigned poem here:</i> Poem 3: <i>The Corner of the Road</i> <u>Bangl</u> Silently, it dragged its leg and limped enduring the pain of its bleeding limb. Silently, it sniffed, licked, and crowed, all alone at the corner of the road. Green river, it gushed out of the <u>lake of red</u>; Golden furs, they drifted as they get <u>shed</u>. Lifelessly, it laid; Hopelessly, it <u>waited</u> all alone at the corner of the <u>road</u>. That night, there was nothing but happiness; <u>No more</u> lively nights, no more midnight fights; <u>No more</u> familiar barks, no more territories marked. No more of its familiar presence, yet no one questioned, and no one realised, as its remnants laid all alone at the corner of the road.

Literary Device	An Example from the Poem	Purpose
Onomatopoeia	"Bang!"	The use of this word phonetically mimics the loud, sudden sound of the collision. It serves to instantly shock the reader, setting a violent and alarming tone right at the beginning, effectively marking the abrupt transition from calmness to tragedy.
Metaphor	"...gushed out of the lake of red"	This phrase compares the large pool of blood to a "lake". This comparison exaggerates the volume of blood to emphasize the severity of the injury. It creates a vivid and gruesome image that evokes a feeling of horror and pity , forcing the reader to visualize the extent of the animal's suffering.
Repetition	"...all alone at the corner of the road."	This phrase is repeated at the end of each stanza. Its purpose is to constantly remind the reader of the animal's isolation. By anchoring every scene with this line, the poet reinforces the message of abandonment and the heartbreaking reality that the animal's pain goes unnoticed by the world.

TOTAL PO1 (5%)	_____ /12 marks
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Based on the assigned poem, answer the following questions.

1. What is the message of the poem?

The poem conveys a poignant message about the apathy and indifference of society towards the suffering of stray animals. It highlights the tragic reality of a hit-and-run incident where a living creature is left to endure pain and eventually die in complete isolation, unnoticed by the humans around it

(2 marks)

2. What is the tone of the poem?

The tone of the poem is predominantly **somber, grim, and melancholic**. It begins with a tone of violence and shock due to the accident, then shifts into a pitiful and sorrowful mood as it describes the animal's struggle, finally ending with a sense of hopelessness and finality.

(2 marks)

3. Whose point of view is the poem written in? Provide evidence from the poem.

The poem is written from the **third-person point of view**, likely that of a detached observer. The narrator describes the animal using the pronoun "it" (for example: "it dragged its leg," "it sniffed") and details the events objectively from the outside without participating in the scene

(2 marks)

4. Do the devices used in the poem help to convey the message and the tone effectively?

Justify your answers with two examples from the poem.

Yes, the literary devices are highly effective in conveying the tragic message and somber tone of the poem.

Firstly, the use of **Metaphor** in the line "gushed out of the lake of red" creates a powerful visual image of the injury. By comparing the blood to a "lake," the poet emphasises the brutality of the

accident, which helps to evoke a strong emotional response of pity and horror in the reader, aligning perfectly with the poem's grim tone.

Secondly, the **Repetition** of the phrase "all alone at the corner of the road" acts as a refrain that hammers home the central theme of neglect. This technique ensures that the message of the animal's solitude is constantly at the forefront of the reader's mind, making the ending—where the animal dies unnoticed—feel even more tragic and impactful.

(4 marks)

TOTAL PO3 (10%)	_____/10 marks
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Task 2: Revised Free Form Poem

Task Description

Based on the evaluation of the selected poem in Task 1, produce an **improved version** of the poem that **contains the same tone, message and structure**. You may improve the literary devices used. You may also add other literary devices that could help to convey the tone and message better. **Underline the changes**.

Write your poem here: **The Corner of the Road (Revised)**

Crash!

Trembling it dragged its **shattered** leg and limped,
enduring the **burn** of its bleeding limb.

Softly, it sniffed, licked, and **whimpered low**, all alone at the corner of the road.

A crimson stream, it gushed **painting the asphalt red**;

Golden fur, they drifted **like leaves widely spread**.

Motionless, it remained; Hopelessly, it waited
all alone at the corner of the road.

That night, there was nothing but **silence and darkness**;

No more lively nights, no more midnight fights;

No more familiar barks, no more territories marked.

No more of its familiar presence, yet no one questioned,

no eves sympathized. as its **spirit** laid all alone at the corner of the road.

TOTAL PO4 (10%)	_____ /10 marks
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